

look for it). Set a key by pressing [S] on that frame. Now go on the other keyed frame, which is frame 24 and rotate it again. Press [S] when you're satisfied with it. Do the same kind of rotation on every frame where you see the key, keeping in mind that the rotation should be subtle and in the flow. Any absurd rotation can make it look really weird.

Once you are through with the rotation animation, view it by clicking the play button. To start off with the stretch and squash effect, go to the frame where you see the ball lands on the ground, the same frame where we set our keyframe. Left-click and select the ball. Next select animation from the Menu box. In the create deformers dropdown, go to **NonLinear > Squash**. This will add a deformer to the ball. A deformer is nothing but a set of attributes that change the formation of the ball and gives you complete control to manipulate its shape. You will see a thin line in the middle of the balls.

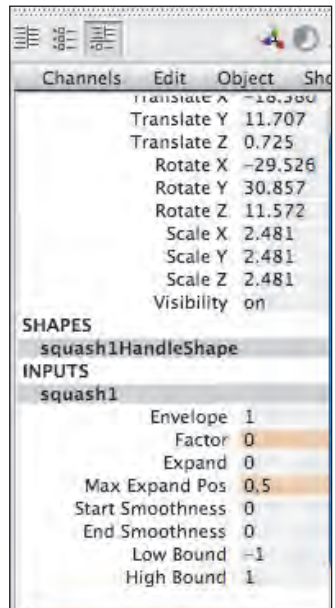
You will see that it has a few options inside, for this illustration we will be using Factor and Max Expand Position.

Factor

Specifies the amount of squashing or stretching. Increasing negative values specify squashing along deformer's local Y-axis. Increasing positive values specify stretching along deformer's local Y-axis. Use the slider to select values from -10.0000 to 10.0000. Default is 0.0000 (no squashing or stretching).

Max Expand Position

Specifies the centre of maximum expansion between the high bound position and the low bound position. Values can be between 0.01000 (near the low bound position) and 0.9900 (near the high bound position). Use the slider to select values from 0.0100 to 0.9900. Default value is 0.5000. Before you can change any of the values, you need to position your deformer in a straight line if it is facing horizontally or diagonally.



Keeping the line selected, go to the channels box and locate something squash1 and click on it